



UP Warriorz (owned by Capri Global) and Gujarat Giants (owned by Adani Sportsline) didn't benefit from home-ground support. However, both franchises are eager to build dedicated local fan bases this time.

"The response to the WPL over the last two seasons has been phenomenal, and the league's expansion to new regions is truly heartening," said Sanjay Adesara, Chief Business Officer of Adani Sportsline.

The turnout at Kotambi Stadium during December's ODIs was an encouraging sign, with nearly 10,000 spectators attending each match. The Gujarat Giants is keen to capitalise on this momentum.

"With the Indian women's team having played international matches at the Kotambi Stadium, this is another significant step forward for women's cricket in India. We are thrilled by this opportunity," Adesara said.

UP Warriorz owner Jinisha Sharma echoed this sentiment, calling the

Maiden win: Royal Challengers Bengaluru claimed its first Women's Premier League title with an eight-wicket victory over Delhi Capitals in the final in Delhi last year.

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

expansion a vital step for the league and her franchise. "As a newer name in the sporting industry, it's crucial for us to grow the WPL and our franchise by taking this experience to multiple cities," she said.

"Mumbai and Bengaluru have been privileged with packed crowds over the years, and rightly so. As a franchise preparing to play at our home ground for the first time, we're incredibly excited," Sharma added.

To prepare for its home debut, UP Warriorz conducted groundwork in Lucknow and other cities in Uttar Pradesh last year. "We learned a lot from interacting with students, faculty, media, and others to understand what would resonate with local fans," Sharma explained.

"This month, we're organising a



Players to watch out

RCB

Smriti Mandhana, Joshitha VJ

MI

Harmanpreet Kaur, G. Kamalini

Gujarat Giants

Deandra Dottin, Simran Shaikh

Delhi Capitals

Meg Lanning, Nandini Kashyap

UP Warriorz

Chamari Athapaththu, Saima Thakor